



Maritime &
Coastguard
Agency

Guidance

MGN 375 (M+F) Maritime safety information Amendment 1

Updated 19 December 2022

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Notice to all Shipowners, Masters, Superintendents and Skippers of Fishing Vessels, Yachts and Other Seagoing Craft.

This notice replaces This notice replaces Marine Guidance Notes 23, and 44 and 375.

Summary

Maritime Safety Information (MSI) is defined in the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS) Convention, Chapter IV as “navigational and meteorological warnings, meteorological forecasts and other urgent safety related messages broadcast to ships.”

The Global Maritime Distress and Safety System (GMDSS) supports two systems for broadcasting MSI:

- The International NAVTEX Service
- The International Enhanced Group Calling (EGC) Service
 - The International SafetyNET Service
 - The Iridium SafetyCast Service

The United Kingdom NAVTEX station coverage area is given in section 4.3 and is complemented by VHF and MF radiotelephony.

This Notice provides guidance about the principal sources of relevant information. Masters, skippers and others should refer to Maritime and Coastguard Agency (MCA/064) leaflet via the MCA website at www.mcga.gov.uk (<http://www.mcga.gov.uk>) for details, copies can also be obtained from MCA offices.

Masters, skippers and others should use every available means to obtain the latest MSI.

1. Introduction/background

1.1 The Maritime and Coastguard Agency (MCA) is responsible in the UK for the broadcast of Maritime Safety Information (MSI) on NAVTEX, VHF and MF and for the provision of the Telemedical Assistance (TMAS) Service.

1.2 To ensure that the user knows when to receive MSI for a given area and subject, many MSI broadcasts are scheduled in accordance with International Maritime Organization (IMO) guidance. For example, all navigational warnings and meteorological forecasts are scheduled broadcasts, while meteorological warning and distress alerts and certain urgent navigational warnings are unscheduled broadcasts.

1.3 NAVTEX receivers should be programmed to receive information from the Radio Stations covering the area in which the ship is navigating, is about to enter, or adjacent NAVTEX transmission sites. The International EGC Facility (SafetyNet and SafetyCast services) should be logged on to the appropriate satellite for broadcasting MSI to the area in which the ship is navigating or is about to enter; this may require monitoring broadcasts from separate satellites.

2. Navigational Warnings

2.1 Full use should be made of NAVTEX, International EGC Service (SafetyNET or SafetyCast), HF, MF and VHF radio to obtain the most up-to-date Radio Navigational Warnings.

2.2 Details of the UK COASTAL and NAVAREA elements of the Worldwide Navigational Warnings Service (WWNWS) are set out in the Admiralty List of Radio Signals volume 3 (NP 283).

2.3 A list of current UK Coastal and NAVAREA I Warnings is published in Section III of Admiralty Weekly Notices to Mariners and are also available on the UKHO website at www.ukho.gov.uk (<http://www.ukho.gov.uk>). Although this list may be kept updated, it should be borne in mind that approved method of receiving MSI is as noted in 2.1 above.

3. Weather Information

3.1 Weather information for commercial shipping can be obtained at a number of UK ports or direct from the Met Office by telephoning 0370 900 0100. Forecasts are also available via the Met Office website at www.metoffice.gov.uk (<http://www.metoffice.gov.uk>)

3.2 At sea, full use should be made of weather information (including gale and storm warnings and strong wind warnings for inshore waters) broadcast on NAVTEX, International EGC Services, MF and VHF radio.

3.3 His Majesty's Coastguard Maritime Rescue Co-ordination Centres (MRCC) broadcast weather information on Radio Telephony (RT) as follows:

- Sea Area (Shipping Forecast)- twice a day
- Gale Warnings – on receipt and every 3 days
- Strong Wind Warnings – on receipt becoming part of the next Inshore Forecast; and
- Inshore Forecasts up to 12 nautical miles offshore – new every 6 hours, repeated after 3 hours.

3.4 Skippers of yachts, in particular, should listen to weather forecasts broadcast on local and national radio, the repetition of meteorological information relayed by the MRCC service, and refer to other sources which can be found in all good nautical almanacs.

3.5 The definitions of visibility in nautical miles (nm) have been standardised and based on the following:

- Very Poor: less than 0.5nm
- Poor: 0.5nm to 2 nm
- Moderate: 2nm to 5nm
- Good: greater than 5nm

4. NAVTEX

4.1 The coverage area of a NAVTEX station is an arc of a circle having a radius from the transmitter where signals may be received, whereas the service area is the area for which MSI is available from a NAVTEX transmitter

4.2 Full details of these service and coverage areas can be found in Admiralty List of Radio Signals Volumes 3 and 5. Masters should satisfy themselves that the Officers of the Watch are aware of the need to inform them of the content of navigational and meteorological warnings and weather forecasts.

4.3 NAVTEX SERVICE AREAS (Refer to Annex 1 diagram)

Cullercoats	S. North Sea, E. Coast of England and E.& N. Coasts of Scotland to 62°N.
Portpatrick	N.W. Approaches to UK, W. Scotland, N. Channel, Irish Sea and St George's Channel and E. Coast of Ireland.
Niton	S.W. Approaches N. of 48°27'N, English Channel, Celtic Sea and Dover Strait.
Oostende	S. North Sea and Dover Strait.

4.4 The 518 kHz NAVTEX service provides MSI and additional weather information as follows:

Activity	Cullercoats – 518 kHz [G]	Niton – 518 kHz [E]	Portpatrick - 518 kHz [O]
Gale Warnings on receipt and at	0100, 0500, 0900, 1300, 1700, 2100	0040, 0440, 0840, 1240, 1640, 2040	0220, 0620, 1020, 1420, 1820, 2220
Shipping Forecast 24 Hour Forecast & 24 Hour Outlook	0900, 2100	0840, 2040	0620, 1820
Extended Outlook (3-5 days)	0100	0040	0220
WZ Navigational Warnings	0100, 0500, 0900, 1300, 1700, 2100	0040, 0440, 0840, 1240, 1640, 2040	0220, 0620, 1020, 1420, 1820, 2220

Activity	Cullercoats – 518 kHz [G]	Niton – 518 kHz [E]	Portpatrick - 518 kHz [O]
Tidal Surge Warnings S. North Sea	On receipt	On receipt	On receipt
SUBFACTS	-	0440, 1640	0620, 1820
NAVAREA I Warnings	0500, 1700	0440, 1640	0220, 1420

4.5 The National 490kHz NAVTEX service also provides the Inshore Waters Forecast (IWF) and Strong Wind Warnings on receipt. Weather Actual Reports are broadcast once only at the next available broadcast schedule as indicated below.

Activity	Cullercoats – 490 kHz [U]	Niton – 490 kHz [I]	Portpatrick - 490 kHz [C]
Inshore Forecast	0720, 1920	0520, 1720	0820, 2020
Weather Actual – latest observations	0320, 1120, 1520, 2320	0120, 0920, 1320, 2120	0020, 0420, 1220, 1620

4.6 The broadcast of MSI may be interrupted or delayed as a result of Search and Rescue operations. Any broadcast issues relating to NAVTEX should be addressed to the nearest HMCG MRCC or the SAR Communications Manager on 0344 382 0043.

4.7 Use of Abbreviations in NAVTEX Weather Broadcasts (Refer to Annex 2 table)

From 1 November 2006 a range of standard abbreviations were introduced to weather forecasts broadcast on the international NAVTEX (518 kHz) service. This change has been necessary to reduce the length of forecasts and overrunning.

More information

UK Technical Services Navigation Branch
Maritime and Coastguard Agency
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Spring Place
105 Commercial Road
Southampton
SO15 1EG

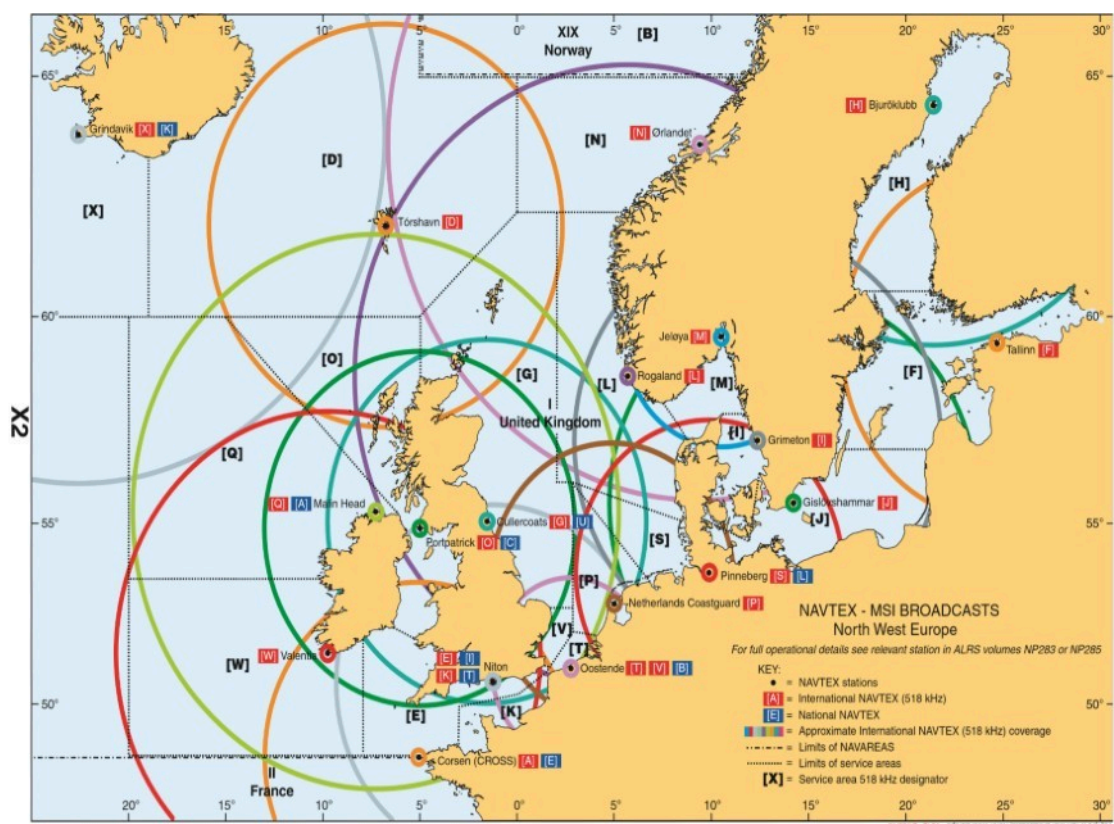
Telephone: +44 (0)203 81 72000

Email: marinesafetyinformation@mcga.gov.uk

Website: www.gov.uk/mca (<https://www.gov.uk/mca>)

General enquiries: infoline@mcga.gov.uk

Annex 1



Navtex MSI Broadcast Areas in NAVAREA 1

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Annex 2

Common Abbreviations for international NAVTEX service

NAVTEX Abbreviations	Terminology in full
N	North or Northerly
NE	Northeast or Northeasterly
E	East or Easterly
SE	Southeast or Southeasterly
S	South or Southerly
SW	Southwest or Southwesterly
W	West or Westerly
NW	Northwest or Northwesterly
DECR	Decreasing
INCR	Increasing
VRB	Variable
BECMG	Becoming
LOC	Locally
MOD	Moderate
OCNL	Occasionally
SCT	Scattered
TEMPO	Temporarily/Temporary
ISOL	Isolated
FRQ	Frequent/Frequency

NAVTEX Abbreviations	Terminology in full
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SHWRS or SH	Showers
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C-FRONT or CFNT	Cold Front
-----------------	------------

W-FRONT or WFNT	Warm Front
-----------------	------------

O-FRONT or OFNT	Occlusion Front
-----------------	-----------------

WKN	Weakening
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BLDG	Building
------	----------

FLN	Filling
-----	---------

DPN	Deepening
-----	-----------

INTSF	Intensifying/Intensify
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IMPR	Improving/Improve
------	-------------------

STNR	Stationary
------	------------

QSTNR	Quasi-Stationary
-------	------------------

MVG or MOV	Moving/Move
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VEER	Veering
------	---------

BACK	Backing
------	---------

SLWY	Slowly
------	--------

QCKY	Quickly
------	---------

RPDY	Rapidly
------	---------

KT	Knots
----	-------

KMH	Km/h
-----	------

NM	Nautical miles
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M	Metres
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NAVTEX Abbreviations	Terminology in full
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HPA	HectoPascal
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MET	Meteo
-----	-------

FCST	Forecast
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TEND	Further outlooks
------	------------------

VIS	Visibility
-----	------------

SLGT or SLT	Slight
-------------	--------

QUAD	Quadrant
------	----------

POSS	Possible
------	----------

PROB	Probability/Probable
------	----------------------

SIG	Significant
-----	-------------

NC	No change
----	-----------

NOSIG	No significant change
-------	-----------------------

FLW	Following
-----	-----------

NXT	Next
-----	------

HVY	Heavy
-----	-------

SEV or SVR	Severe
------------	--------

STRG	Strong
------	--------

FM	From
----	------

EXP	Expected
-----	----------

LAT/LONG	Latitude/Longitude
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OGI

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